sorts of words diminish or keep small and safe their enterprises. Calling their business their baby or using the word 'just' is part of a language and values shift that we as women need to start calling each other out on. It's a minimising financial story, a scarcity mindset that's designed to keep us small and encourage others to be small with us. Yet it's a Money Story that women seem to overwhelmingly believe. And here's the rub—when women *do* succeed, some of us take pot shots at them because they make us feel less than.

Now, this is only one example of how a Money Story can affect women's financial behaviour and it leads us to believe the Money Story that women are worse at money than men. Trust me: I can offer so many more examples: in business, in the home, with our superannuation, with conversations relating to child rearing, superannuation splitting and more.

But are our Money Stories self-actualising? Because of their Money Stories, are women worse investors and savers than men? The answer is an emphatic no.

Recent studies suggest that women are in fact better investors than men. In 2008, Warwick Business School researchers tracked the performance of 2,800 UK men and women over three years. They discovered that women not only outperformed the men during that period, they also surpassed the Financial Times Stock Exchange 100 over that same period. Contrast that to a Fidelity Investments 2019 Women and Money survey in the United States where only 9 per cent of those surveyed believed women were better investors than men. Over 90 per cent believed the Money Story that women are poor investors. This raises the question: How many women are not investing because they too believe this Money Story, despite the fact that research proves it to be false?

Money myths and Money Stories might seem antiquated, strange, even amusing, but too often I see them destabilising our finances and causing us to sabotage ourselves without understanding why. The issue when it comes to both our Money Stories and our Money Types (which I'll expand on in Part Two) is that we don't talk about money—in our schools, at home or with our peers. Sure, the media will discuss property prices and calamatise, whether property is out of reach or the bottom has dropped out of the market. Or they'll fuel market panic with catastrophic 24-hour messaging during a crisis, such as 2020's global virus outbreak and